

What is a tune?

Tune is another word for melody. When pitch and rhythm combine in a seamless entity, the listener hears both parts as a unit and can easily identify the “tune.”

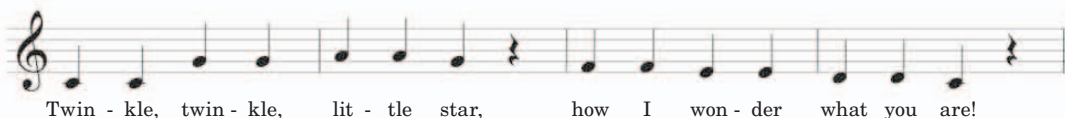
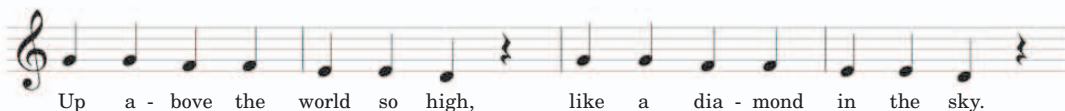
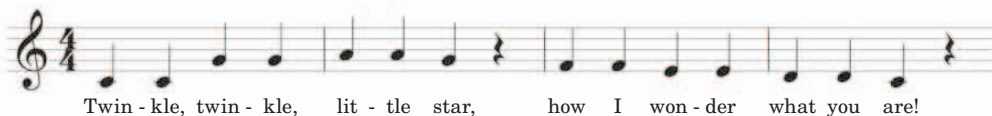
SEE ALSO

◀ 10–11 What is music?

◀ 44–45 Tempo

Familiar tunes

Singable, hummable, or whistleable, familiar tunes are “catchy”. This means that they are easy to hear, remember, and repeat. Memorable tunes become familiar ones when they appear over and over in various settings, often with different lyrics or varied instrumentation.

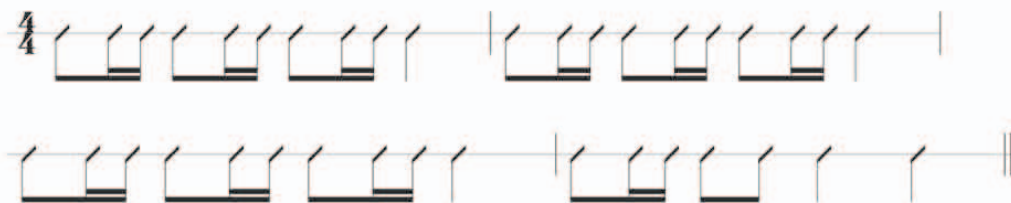


◁ “Twinkle Twinkle”

In this well-known tune, both the order of pitches and the rhythmic pattern are familiar and easy to remember.

Rhythm and melody

As the combination of rhythm and melody is linked to the way a listener hears and remembers a tune, separating and examining them separately is often disorienting. Both parts work together to give a melody its individual and distinctive character.



◁ Rhythmic notation

Shown here is the rhythmic notation, or pitchless notes, placed along a single horizontal line, for a tune you probably know. You may be able to guess it from the rhythm alone.



◁ Pitches

Here are only the pitches for the same melody, with no rhythm, no time signature, bar lines, or note lengths.